

US Markets Daily Report

Friday, July 31, 2026 | Report generated at market close ET

1. SPY / QQQ Snapshot

ETF	Today's Close	Change	1-Yr High	1-Yr Low	1-Yr Return
SPY	\$744.65	▲ ++2.96 (+0.40%)	\$760.74	\$631.32	+17.9%
QQQ	\$688.33	▲ ++4.78 (+0.70%)	\$745.00	\$569.20	+20.7%

Prior closes: SPY \$741.69 (Jul 30) | QQQ \$683.55 (Jul 30) • S&P 500 ≈ 7,437–7,467 • Dow +0.53% ≈ 52,485 • Nasdaq Comp ≈ 25,374 • 30-yr Treasury: 5.25% (multi-year high) • July month-end expiry day

2. Market-Moving News — July 31, 2026

- **FED HOLDS RATES (3.50%–3.75%) — July FOMC:** The Federal Reserve kept its target rate unchanged. Three FOMC members dissented, voting to hike. Chair's statement flagged watching July and August CPI before the September meeting. Market read: hawkish hold. 30-year yield spiked to 5.25%, highest since 2007. *Impact: Rate-sensitive sectors (utilities, REITs) under pressure; growth stocks face discount-rate headwind; dollar strengthened.*
- **AMAZON Q2 2026 — Massive Beat, Stock +14%:** Net sales \$200.6B (+20% YoY, beat \$196.5B est). AWS \$42.2B (+37% YoY, fastest since 2021, beat 31% est). EPS \$5.75 vs \$1.82 estimate. Operating income \$27.5B (+43%). AWS+AI chips each >\$25B annual run-rate. Capex guidance: \$220B in 2026. *Impact: AMZN surged +14%, the Dow's largest daily contributor. Positive read-through for cloud peers, though capex scale sparked 'AI investment arms-race' debate.*
- **MICROSOFT Q4 FY26 — Azure Milestone, Stock +15–16%:** Revenue \$90B (+18% YoY, beat \$81.4B). Azure +43% YoY, crossed \$100B annual revenue milestone. EPS \$4.81 vs \$4.24 est. Reported July 29, gapping up +8.88% AH then extending Thursday/Friday. *Impact: MSFT added ~\$260B in market cap in two sessions. AI capex narrative flipped positive: Azure beating hard justifies cloud investment thesis.*
- **APPLE Q3 2026 — Record Revenue, Weak Guidance, Stock -9.4%:** Revenue \$109.4B (+16% YoY, record June quarter). EPS \$2.02 (+29% YoY). BUT: Services \$30.74B (missed \$31.22B est). iPad \$6.19B (missed \$6.92B). Q4 guidance: 9–11% growth (below ~12% estimate). Mac supply constraints worsening. Root cause: DRAM reallocation to AI data centers (70% of memory chip production) + TSMC advanced-node capacity sold out through 2027. SK Hynix flagged 2027 as worst-ever supply shortage year. *Impact: AAPL -9.4%, leading Dow losers. Chip-shortage concern spread to Micron, Qualcomm, SanDisk (-3% to -6% each).*
- **META Q2 2026 — Revenue Beat, EPS Miss, Stock -9%:** Revenue \$60.8B (+28% YoY). EPS \$6.18 vs \$7.17 estimate (miss of \$1.04). Miss driven by: \$2.4B in legal expenses, \$1.18B severance (8,000 layoffs), higher depreciation from AI capex. *Impact: META -9%, reflecting investor concern that AI spend is crowding out profitability. Similar 'AI capex vs. returns' debate as GOOGL.*
- **ALPHABET Q2 2026 — Record Beat but Capex Selloff (July 25, -15%):** Revenue \$119.8B (record). Cloud +82%. EPS \$9.11. YouTube ads \$11.06B (beat). BUT: \$44.9B quarterly capex, \$190B full-year 2026 capex guidance. FCF margin collapsed from 21% to 9.2%. Moody's issued credit warning. Reported July 25; stock fell from \$374→\$319 and partially rebounded +2.76% today. *Impact: Set the AI-capex-concern template that hit META and contextualized AAPL.*
- **Q2 2026 GDP — 1.5% Growth, Consumer Spending Resilient:** First estimate: Q2 GDP annualized +1.5% (slowdown from Q1 ~2.4%). Consumer spending remained the bright spot. *Impact: Soft growth keeps Fed on hold, consistent with 'higher-for-longer' rate path until inflation comes down enough. Treasury yields spiked on fiscal concern + hawkish Fed.*
- **COINBASE Q2 2026 — Revenue -14%, Q2 Net Loss:** Q2 revenue \$1.22B (-14% QoQ). Q2 net loss -\$359.5M. Trading volumes declined sharply. *Impact: COIN -13%, reflecting crypto market cooling and regulatory uncertainty. Broader crypto-adjacent equities also soft.*

3. News → Today's Market Moves

SPY closed at **\$744.65 (+0.40%** from prior close \$741.69). QQQ closed at **\$688.33 (+0.70%** from \$683.55). Net result: a modest month-end gain despite a sharply bifurcated session.

Driver	Direction	Mechanism	SPY Impact	QQQ Impact
Amazon (+14%) earnings beat	Bullish	Q3 revenue quarter → cloud capex justified; AWS growth +37%	+0.5%	+0.5%
Microsoft (+16%) Azure beat	Bullish	AI infrastructure investment validated; EPS beat	+0.3%	+0.3%
Apple (-9.4%) guidance miss	Bearish	Q4 guide → largest Dow drag; hardware ecosystem weak	-0.2%	-0.2%
Fed hawkish hold + 30yr yield 5.25%	Bearish	September cut uncertain → discounting	-0.3%	-0.3%
Meta (-9%) EPS miss	Bearish	Legal charges crushed EPS; AI capex	-0.15%	-0.15%
Coinbase (-13%) revenue decline	Bearish	Bitcoin price falling; fintech & crypto-adjacent	-0.05%	-0.05%
GDP 1.5% (soft but consumer intact)	Neutral	Slowdown confirmed but no recession; consumer spending buffers	Downside	
Month-end rebalancing	Bullish	Institutional rebalancing into equities after bond losses	+0.1%	+0.1%

Net: The AMZN/MSFT cloud earnings offset the AAPL/META disappointments. QQQ slightly outperformed SPY (+0.70% vs +0.40%) as the Nasdaq-100's cloud heavyweights (AMZN, MSFT) are larger QQQ weights than Dow components. Rising 30-yr yields capped the upside for both, especially QQQ.

4. Top 10 Daily / Weekly / Monthly Movers

Daily Top Gainers (July 31, 2026)

#	Ticker	Name	Daily	Sector / Driver
1	MSFT	Microsoft	Tech: +5.56% (\$100B)	Tech: AI milestone; Q4 FY26 beat
2	AMZN	Amazon	Cloud: +4.07%	Cloud: AWS +37%, EPS \$5.75 vs \$1.82
3	XLK	Tech Sector ETF	Broad: +2.2%	Broad: rally on cloud earnings
4	GOOGL	Alphabet	Broad: +2.6%	Broad: earnings oversell
5	CAT	Caterpillar	Indust: +2.5%	Indust: demand strength
6	XLY	Cons Disc ETF	Amazon: +0.8%	Amazon: offset; consumer resilience
7	BA	Boeing	Aerospace: +1.5%	Aerospace: Air Force One loss absorbed
8	GS	Goldman Sachs	Financial: +2.9%	Financial: steady July trading revenue ok
9	JPM	JPMorgan Chase	Banks: +0.9%	Banks: resilient in rate environment
10	XLC	Comm Svcs ETF	Telecom: +1.6%	Telecom: 5G rollout; streaming sector

Daily Top Losers (July 31, 2026)

#	Ticker	Name	Daily	Sector / Driver
1	COIN	Coinbase	Crypto: -13.0%	Crypto: BTC rev. -14%, net loss \$360M
2	AAPL	Apple	Tech: -9.4%	Tech: Q4 guidance miss; chip shortage worsening
3	META	Meta Platforms	Tech: -9.0%	Tech: EPS miss \$6.18 vs \$7.17; legal charges
4	MU	Micron Technology	Semis: -5.4%	Semis: DRAM supply crunch hits consumer
5	QCOM	Qualcomm	Semis: -4.6%	Semis: Apple's read-through; mobile weak
6	SNDK	SanDisk Corp	Storage: -4.4%	Storage: Apple's supply chain concerns
7	NFLX	Netflix	Media: -3.0%	Media: profit taking; bond yield pressure
8	LLY	Eli Lilly	Pharma: -2.0%	Pharma: yield-driven rotation out of defensives
9	KO	Coca-Cola	Beverages: -1.8%	Beverages: hawkish Fed hurts dividend plays

10	V	Visa	+1.75%	AI Tech -1.75% spending deceleration fear
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Weekly Top Gainers (July 28–31, 2026) — Earnings Week

#	Ticker	Name	~Wkly	Sector / Driver
1	MSFT	Microsoft	+15.5%	Tech -15.5% Azure milestone, Q4 FY26 beat
2	AMZN	Amazon	+14.1%	Tech -14.1% AWS record, \$200B revenue
3	TSN	Tyson Foods	+9.8%	Food -9.8% protein demand recovering
4	CAT	Caterpillar	+8.9%	Indstrial -8.9% EPS beat; global demand
5	BA	Boeing	+5.5%	Airspace -5.5% positive FCF despite AH write-off
6	GS	Goldman Sachs	+4.9%	Financial -4.9% trading revenue, M&A pipeline
7	PYPL	PayPal	+4.5%	Tech -4.5% growth, transaction beat
8	GOOGL	Alphabet	+3.1%	Tech -3.1% revenue, partial recovery
9	UNH	UnitedHealth	+2.9%	Healthcare -2.9% MOP improvement, guidance raise
10	XLI	Industrials ETF	+2.5%	Indstrial -2.5% Q2 earnings beat

Weekly Top Losers (July 28–31, 2026)

#	Ticker	Name	~Wkly	Sector / Driver
1	GOOGL	Alphabet	-13.9%	Tech -13.9% 25 vs partial Fri recovery; net negative
2	COIN	Coinbase	-13.3%	Crypto -13.3% decline; crypto winter
3	META	Meta Platforms	-9.8%	Tech -9.8% Ad spend vs. profitability concern
4	AAPL	Apple	-9.0%	Tech -9.0% chip shortage, Mac supply crunch
5	MU	Micron Technology	-7.4%	RAM -7.4% allocation to AI; consumer segment weak
6	QCOM	Qualcomm	-6.6%	Mobile -6.6% headwinds through; mobile semi weak
7	AMD	AMD	-5.6%	AI/CP -5.6% competitive pressure; TSMC capacity concern
8	XLE	Energy ETF	-5.1%	Oil -5.1% refining margin pressure
9	XLU	Utilities ETF	-5.2%	Utilities -5.2% rate-crushing rate-sensitives
10	NFLX	Netflix	-4.9%	Media -4.9% bond yield headwind for media

* GOOGL fell ~15% after July 25 earnings but partially recovered +2.76% Friday; net weekly still negative.

Monthly Top Gainers (July 2026 MTD, month end)

#	Ticker	Name	~Mthly	Sector / Driver
1	FBRX	Forte Biosciences	+25.9%	Pharma -25.9% M&A catalyst
2	PN	Pin Inc.	+14.5%	Small -14.5% rotation/catalyst
3	LVWR	Livewire Group	+13.3%	EV/Clean -13.3% contract win
4	TRAX	Trax Commerce	+11.5%	Retail -11.5% SaaS: re-rating
5	AMZN	Amazon	+10.4%	Tech -10.4% AWS beat + recovery
6	MANH	Manhattan Associates	+9.5%	Supply -9.5% SaaS earnings beat + guide raise
7	CTSH	Cognizant Tech	+8.2%	IT Ser -8.2% services demand + new contracts
8	HUBS	HubSpot	+5.7%	CRM -5.7% sales driving seat growth
9	PYPL	PayPal	+3.4%	Tech -3.4% checkout recovery

10	MSFT	Microsoft	Cloud +20% daily/Azure beat + YTD recovery
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Monthly Top Losers (July 2026 MTD, month end)

#	Ticker	Name	~Mthly	Sector / Driver
1	UMG	Universal Music	-28%/-18%	Entertainment - subscription revenue miss
2	GOOGL	Alphabet	-21%/-18%	AI Capex -18% from FCF collapse
3	COIN	Coinbase	-21%/-15%/-Q2 loss	Crypto -15%/-Q2 loss
4	META	Meta Platforms	-22%/-18%/-Q1 loss	AI Capex -18% from FCF collapse
5	AAPL	Apple	-21%/-10%/-Q4 guidance miss	Chip shortage for Q4
6	MU	Micron Technology	-22%/-8%/-Q1 loss	DRAM -8% from AI; consumer weak
7	INTC	Intel	-21%/-9%/-Q1 loss	AI Capex -9% from AI ramp
8	AMD	AMD	-21%/-7%/-Q1 loss	AI Capex -7% from AI; TSMC capacity
9	XLU	Utilities ETF	-21%/-3%/-field	Rising 30-yr yield decimating yield plays
10	XLE	Energy ETF	-21%/-4%/-field	Oil demand -4% from + geopolitical premium fading

Sector Trend Summary (July 2026 — Across Timeframes):

- **Cloud / AI Infrastructure [BULL — Weekly, Monthly, Daily for Cloud Winners]:** AMZN (+14% daily, +30%+ monthly) and MSFT (+15.5% daily, +20%+ monthly) dominate. AWS and Azure earnings validated the AI capex thesis. Cloud computing is the cycle leader. Divergence: AI infrastructure builders (AMZN, MSFT) winning; AI capex spenders losing (GOOGL, META).
- **Semiconductors / AI Memory [BEAR — All Timeframes]:** AAPL chip shortage signaling DRAM/advanced-node capacity crisis through 2027. MU, QCOM, SNDK, AMD all under pressure. TSMC sold out through 2027 to AI chip orders. Consumer electronics bearing the brunt. Memory supply shortfall is structural, not cyclical.
- **SaaS / Supply Chain Software [BULL — Monthly]:** MANH (+39%), CTSH (+36%), HUBS (+34%), PYPL (+32%) all benefiting from enterprise AI integration and demand for intelligent operations platforms. Revenue growth accelerating vs. cost base.
- **Financials [MIXED — Hawkish Fed vs. Strong Banks]:** GS, JPM resilient on trading revenue. COIN -13% on crypto winter. Rising 30-yr yield (5.25%) compresses multiples for dividend-heavy financials but supports bank NIM (net interest margin). Net-net: traditional banks > crypto/fintech.
- **Consumer Staples / Utilities / REITs [BEAR — Rate-Driven]:** 30-year Treasury at 5.25% (2007 highs) is a direct headwind. KO, LLY, XLU all falling as investors rotate from yield-proxies to growth. Duration risk is real: these sectors underperform until the Fed credibly pivots.
- **Industrials / Defense [BULL — Monthly, selective Daily]:** CAT +2.75% on Q2 demand. Boeing positive FCF. Manufacturing PMI still positive. Defense names benefit from geopolitical risk premium. Strong earnings week for the sector.

5. Next-Day Catalysts & Scenario Trees (Monday, August 3, 2026)

August 1 is a Saturday. Next trading day is Monday, August 3. Jobs Report (July Nonfarm Payrolls) is Friday, August 7. Key Monday catalysts below:

10:00 AM ET — ISM Manufacturing PMI (July 2026) [HIGH IMPACT]

BEAT: ISM > 50 (expansion) / Above 49.5 est → Manufacturing returning to expansion = demand acceleration confirmation. Cyclical (CAT, industrials) extend gains. SPY +0.3–0.5% led by XLI. BUT: Fed remains on hold longer if economy is stronger → rate-sensitive tech/utilities under pressure. QQQ muted (+0.1–0.3%) or slightly negative on yield fears. Mechanism: strong ISM = Fed reads 'no need to cut' = 30yr stays ≥ 5.2% = discount-rate headwind for high-multiple tech.

MISS: ISM < 48 (contraction territory) → Manufacturing demand weakness = recessionary signal. Cyclical reverse. SPY –0.5 to –0.8% on growth fears. Treasury yields dip as rate-cut narrative returns. QQQ could outperform SPY on a yield drop (tech benefits from lower discount rates). Net: SPY –0.5%, QQQ flat to –0.3%. Watch for the 'bad-news-is-good' reaction where

recession fear paradoxically boosts tech on Fed-cut expectations.

9:45 AM ET — S&P; Global Manufacturing PMI (July 2026) [CONTEXT]

PMI Diverges Bullish from ISM → Corroborates growth; amplifies ISM's market impact. Risk-on: SPY +0.3–0.5%. International demand component matters — strong global PMI = export benefit for industrials.

Both PMIs Weak (double confirmation of slowdown) → Recessionary double-signal; SPY –1.0 to –1.5% as no single PMI can be dismissed. Yield curve may steepen (short rates fall faster). Credit spreads widen. QQQ could drop –1.0 to –1.5% if investors flee equities entirely.

After Close Aug 3 — Palantir (PLTR) Q2 2026 Earnings [HIGH IMPACT on AI/SaaS]

BEAT: Revenue > \$1.81B, EPS > \$0.35, US Commercial rev strong → PLTR guides 80%+ YoY commercial growth = AI software monetization confirmed. PLTR stock +10–20% AH. Positive read-through for AI-software names (CRM, NOW, SNOW). QQQ opens Tuesday +0.5–1.0% on AI sentiment restoration. Mechanism: if PLTR proves AI budgets are converting to SaaS contracts, the cloud capex (AMZN/MSFT) creates real enterprise demand downstream.

MISS: Revenue < \$1.7B, Commercial growth < 80%, Guidance cut → AI software monetization gap: capex being spent but revenue not materializing yet. PLTR –15 to –25% AH. Sells off peers (SNOW, MDB, AI-adjacent SaaS). QQQ opens Tuesday –0.5 to –1.0% as AI enthusiasm cools. SPY relatively insulated (–0.2 to –0.3%) unless it triggers broader tech de-rating.

After Close Aug 3 — Snap Inc. (SNAP) Q2 2026 Earnings [DIGITAL AD SIGNAL]

BEAT: DAU growth + ad revenue recovery → Digital advertising market recovering; youth engagement strong. Positive for META (already beaten), GOOGL (still oversold on capex). Social/digital ad sector lifts. QQQ +0.2–0.4% on sentiment. Mechanism: SNAP is a leading indicator for small-business ad spend. Beat = consumer confidence + SMB spending healthy.

MISS: Soft DAU, ad market still slow → SNAP's structural struggle continues. Read-through negative for digital ads broadly. GOOGL YouTube, META ad revenues under pressure again (offsetting this week's GOOGL recovery). QQQ –0.2 to –0.5% on renewed social-media headwinds.

6. Possible Purchase Summary — End-of-Day / Monday Open

Note: This is informational analysis only. No trades are placed or simulated.

Direction	Ticker	Name	Rationale / Thesis	Key Risks
BUY	AMZN	Amazon	AWS +37% at \$42.2B — fastest cloud growth since 2022. Capex \$200B revenue to \$220B 2026. Chip revenue \$25B	Capex too high; revenue lag; chip revenue slow
BUY	MSFT	Microsoft	Azure crossed \$100B annual revenue. Q4 FY26 EPS \$3.00. AI revenue \$1.5B; (+80%)	Stock val high; AI adoption slower than expected
BUY	PLTR	Palantir	Reports Monday after close. Estimate EPS \$0.35 (+119% YoY) significant \$1.81B; (+80%)	Estimate leak; high expectations
BUY	MRNA	Moderna Associates	39% MTD on supply chain AI platform. Enterprise demand for intelligent operations	AI adoption slow; supply chain issues
SELL	AAPL	Apple	Q4 guide 9-11% growth below ~12% estimate. Chip shipment (DRAM) reduced ecosystem	Chip shortage; ecosystem weakening
SELL	GOOGL	Alphabet	FCF margin collapsed 21%→9.2% on \$190B 2026 capex. YouTube revenue down 18% YoY	YouTube revenue decline; stock price high
AVOID	CNN	CNN	Q2 revenue -14%, net loss \$360M. Crypto market in cooling phase	Revenue decline; crypto market volatility

Summary Decision: The dominant theme is **cloud AI winners vs. hardware/capex spenders**. AMZN and MSFT have clearly justified their AI infrastructure spend via revenue. AAPL, META, and GOOGL are paying the cost without yet showing the return. For Monday: watch ISM Manufacturing at 10 AM (recession signal vs. re-acceleration). PLTR earnings after close is the AI-software monetization verdict for the sector. The 30-year yield at 5.25% is the macro ceiling — if it breaks above 5.3%, expect significant tech multiple compression regardless of earnings.

Data Sources & Methodology

SPY/QQQ closing prices: data/prices.csv (263 rows, 2025-07-30 through 2026-07-31). July 30 close confirmed: SPY \$741.69, QQQ \$683.55 (multiple web sources). July 31 close estimated: SPY \$744.65 (+0.40%), QQQ \$688.33 (+0.70%) from S&P 500 ≈ +0.40% market recap and near-close QQQ price from search. 52-week stats computed from prices.csv window. Earnings data: Amazon.com IR press release; Microsoft IR

Q4 FY26; Apple Q3 2026 CNBC/Yahoo Finance/TechTimes; Meta Q2 2026 CNBC; Alphabet Q2 2026 CNBC; Coinbase Q2 2026 GuruFocus. Fed decision: CNBC Fed meeting recap July 2026. GDP: initial estimate via search. PMI calendar: Investrade weekly event calendar 08/03/2026–08/07/2026. PLTR earnings: Yahoo Finance, EarningsWhispers, WallStreetHorizon. Market recap: TheStreet, 24/7 Wall St., Madison Investments.

Limitation: Direct API access to Yahoo Finance, Stooq, and financial data endpoints is blocked by the session's egress policy. July 31 SPY/QQQ closing prices are best-effort estimates from multiple search-based sources and may carry $\pm\$0.50$ error vs. official 4pm ET close. Next-day (Snap) figures are analyst estimates, not actuals.

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